AfricaCDC
Centres for Disease Control and Prevention

RBM Platform Responsible Person Guide

Responsible Person of the Business Unit

How the submissions of your Business Unit reach you, and how to **approve** them or **reject** them with a reason.

Africa Centres for Disease Control and Prevention
Africa CDC RBM Platform
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INTERNAL USE ONLY

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1 About this guide

You are the **Responsible Person of the Business Unit** (usually the head of division or director), called the Responsible Person in this guide, in the Africa CDC **Results-Based Management (RBM) platform**: the person named as responsible for a Business Unit (BU: a division, a unit or a directorate) in the org structure. You decide on what your Business Unit submits:

What	Submitted by	Your decision
Specific activities of the workplan	The focal person or a staff member of your BU	Approve, or reject with a reason (chapter 4)
Activity reports	Any member of your BU	Approve, or reject with a reason (chapter 6)
Quarterly indicator reports of an indicator your BU contributes to	Your BU, or a BU contributing to your indicator	Approve, or reject with a reason, before M&E signs off (chapter 7)

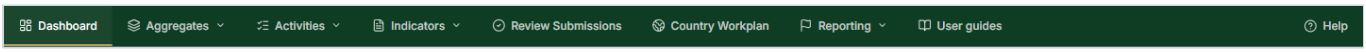
If a BU has no Responsible Person named, the Responsible Person of the Business Unit above it decides for it.

The guide follows the platform as it works on 7 November 2026. The screen captures come from the platform itself, filled with sample data: names, activities and figures are examples. Focal persons and M&E officers have their own guides.

Where to find this guide

In the platform, click **User guides**, the last entry of the main menu. The page lists the guide of each role: **Open** reads it in the browser, **Download** saves the PDF.

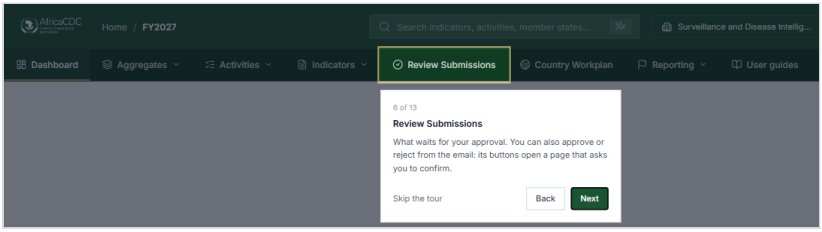
Help, at the right end of the main menu, opens this guide in a new tab on the chapter about the page you are on. On a phone it is at the top of the menu: **Help on this page**.



The main menu ends with User guides, then Help on the right.

The tour

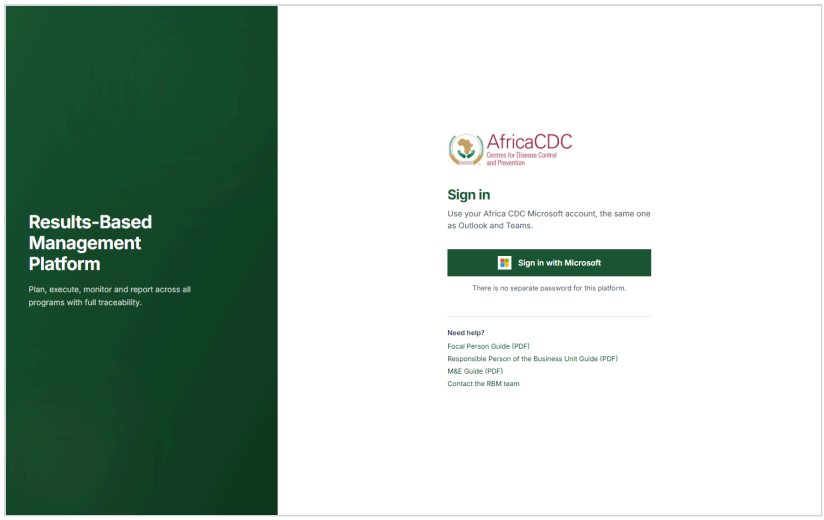
The first time you sign in, a short tour of the screen opens on your home page. Each step points at a part of the screen and says what it is for. Click **Next** and **Back** to move from step to step. **Skip the tour**, or the Escape key, closes it. To take it again, click your initials at the top right, then **Take the tour**.



A step of the tour: it points at Review Submissions.

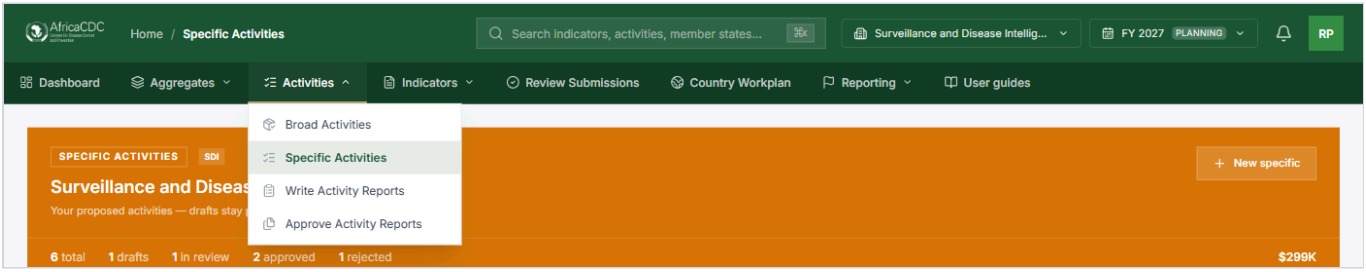
2 Signing in and your menu

Click **Sign in with Microsoft** and use your Africa CDC account, the same one as Outlook and Teams. There is no separate password for the platform.

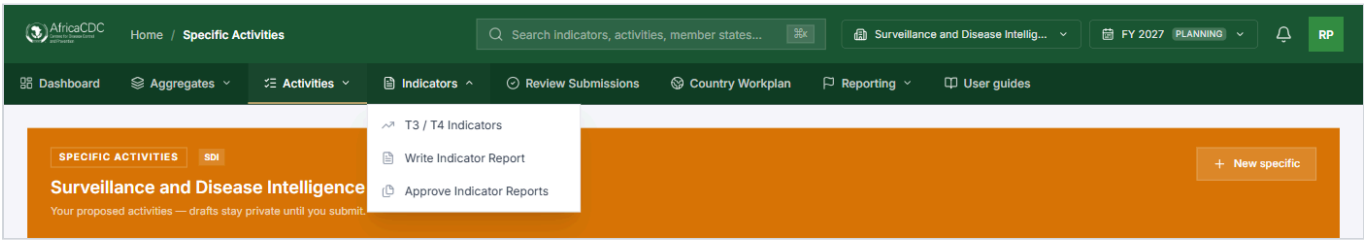


The sign-in screen.

Your menu is the menu of your Business Unit (**Aggregates**, **Activities**, **Indicators**), with three more items for approvers: **Approve Activity Reports**, **Approve Indicator Reports** and **Review Submissions**.



The Activities menu of a Responsible Person ends with Approve Activity Reports.



The Indicators menu ends with Approve Indicator Reports.

Top menu	Item	What it opens
Dashboard		The progress of your Business Unit.
Aggregates ▾	Workplan	The workplan of your Business Unit for the selected year.
	PIRS	The indicators of your Business Unit, as in the PIRS.
	Project Proposal	The project proposal.
	Budget Overview	The budget codes of the broad activities of your Business Unit.

Top menu	Item	What it opens
Activities ▾	Broad Activities	The broad activities of your Business Unit.
	Specific Activities	The specific activities of your Business Unit and their status. **New specific** opens the planning form, if you plan activities yourself.
	Write Activity Reports	Report on what an activity delivered.
	Approve Activity Reports	Review Submissions, tab *Activity Reports* (chapter 6).
Indicators ▾	T3 / T4 Indicators	The Tier 3 and Tier 4 indicators of your Business Unit.
	Write Indicator Report	The quarterly indicator report: the result of each indicator.
	Approve Indicator Reports	Review Submissions, tab *Quarterly Reports* (chapter 7).
Review Submissions		Everything waiting for your decision, in four tabs (chapter 3).
Country Workplan		Only for members of a country office.
Reporting ▾		Big Tickets, the quarterly dashboard, donor reports and the **Monthly Digest** (chapter 9).
User guides		The guide of each role, to read in the browser or download as PDF (chapter 1).

> **Two roles?** If you also hold an administrator role, your pages as a Responsible Person are gathered in one dropdown called **BU**, next to the administration menus.

The BU and year selectors

On the right of the top bar, the **BU selector** chooses one of your Business Units, or **All my divisions**; the **year selector** chooses the fiscal year.

Review Submissions needs a year that has started. If the year selector reads a future year (for example FY 2027 while it is being planned), the page shows *"FY2027 has not started"*: click **Switch to FY2026**. You still see the FY2027 activities waiting for you: the Specific Activities tab lists every year.



Review Submissions while FY 2027 is selected: switch to the current year.

3 How submissions reach you

Emails

When	What you receive
A specific activity of your Business Unit is submitted	*Approval needed: <activity>*, with the name of the person who submitted it, the **Approve** and **Reject** buttons, and an **Open in RBM** button to Review Submissions.
An activity report or a quarterly indicator report of your Business Unit is submitted	*<Report type> submitted: <code> (<quarter> <year>)*, with the content of the report, the period, the author, the attachments, the **Approve** and **Reject** buttons and an **Open the report** button.
Reports still wait for you (every working day)	*<n> reports waiting for your review*: each activity report and quarterly indicator report waiting for you, with its Business Unit, period and date and an *Approve or reject* link, and an **Open Review Submissions** button.
An item has waited more than 7 days for a decision	*An approval is waiting*, to you and to the Responsible Person of the level above, with an **Open and decide** button (below).
A high-risk activity of your Business Unit starts in 14 days or less	*A high-risk activity starts soon*, also sent to the focal person of the activity, with an **Open the activity** button. Once per start date.
A budget execution import is sent to the Business Units and activities of yours are flagged	*Budget execution to look at* (chapter 9).
The first day of each month, if you are the Responsible Person of a directorate	The monthly digest of your directorate, with an **Open the full digest** button (chapter 9).

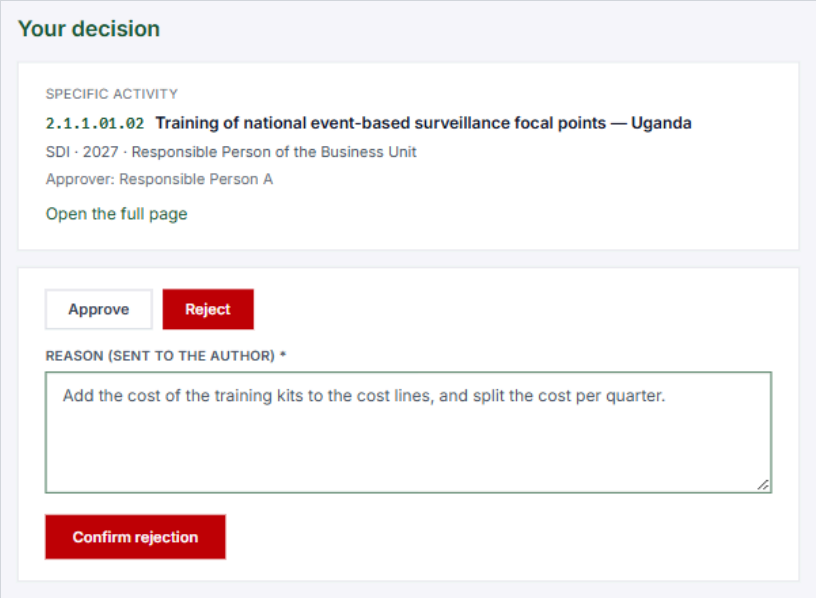
The daily reminder arrives on working days only, at most once a day, while reports wait for you. Specific activities are not in it: their email arrives once, when they are submitted. While you are out of office (chapter 8), your delegate receives a copy of these emails.

Approve or reject from the email

The emails that ask for your decision carry two buttons, **Approve** and **Reject**. Each one opens a page of the platform, **Your decision**, that shows the item (its type, code, title, Business Unit, year and step) and asks you to confirm. Opening the link decides nothing: only the confirm button does.

- **Approve**: click **Confirm approval**.
- **Reject**: write the **Reason (sent to the author) ***, then click **Confirm rejection**. The reason is required.
- You can switch between Approve and Reject on the page before you confirm. **Open the full page** opens the item itself.
- If you are signed out, the platform asks you to sign in, then opens the page.
- If the item was already decided, the page says *This approval is already closed* and who decided it.

The decision is the same as in Review Submissions: the same rules apply and the same emails are sent.



> *The page opened by the Reject button of an email: the item, the reason and Confirm rejection.*

When an approval waits more than 7 days

If an item waits for your decision for more than 7 days, the platform also opens it to the Responsible Person of the level above your Business Unit, for example the director of your directorate. Both of you receive the email *An approval is waiting*, with an **Open and decide** button. You can still decide; whoever decides first closes the step. The 7 days count from the submission, or from the decision of the step before. This happens once per approval step.

If you are the Responsible Person of the level above, the same email reaches you for the items of the Business Units below you: open it and decide, as above.

The bell

The bell in the top bar opens **Your inbox**. It lists what waits for you, for example *"2 specific activities are awaiting your approval"* or *"3 reports awaiting your decision"*, and refreshes every minute. Click an item to open it.

Review Submissions

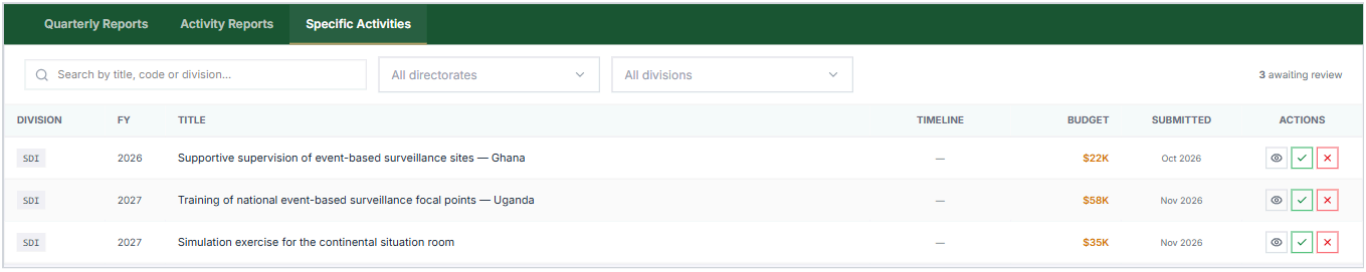
Open **Review Submissions** in the top menu. It gathers everything waiting for your decision, for the Business Units you are responsible for, in tabs:

Tab	What it lists
Quarterly Reports	Quarterly indicator reports, one tab per quarter (chapter 7).
Activity Reports	Reports on specific activities, submitted or still in draft (chapter 6).
Specific Activities	New or changed specific activities waiting for approval (chapter 4).

The directorate and division filters narrow each tab. Users with the export right also see the **Quarterly report Qx** and **Activity reports Qx** buttons, which download the reports of the quarter as Excel or CSV.

4 Approving specific activities

Open **Review Submissions**, tab **Specific Activities**. It lists the activities ■ In Review of the Business Units you are responsible for, for every fiscal year: the **FY** column shows the year of each one, so the activities planned for next year reach you while the current year runs. Search by title, code or division.



The Specific Activities tab: division, FY, title, budget, submission date, and the View, Approve and Reject buttons.

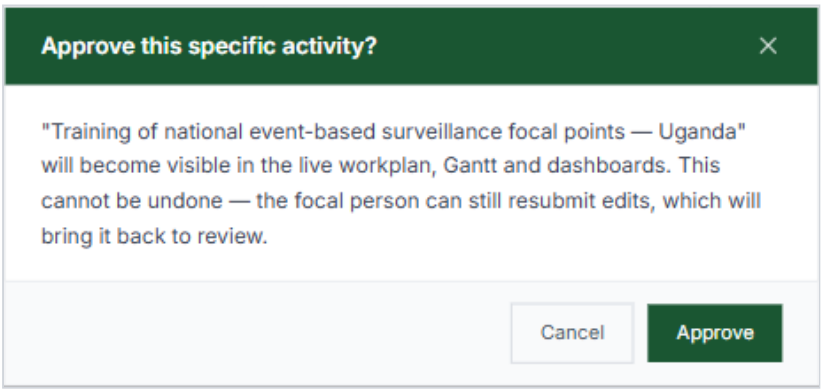
Step 1: Read the activity

Click the **eye** button (*View*). The activity page opens with everything that was planned: details, budget and quarters, the complexity screening, the cost lines, the broad activity and the indicator it serves, and the **Approval trail** (chapter 5).

> The complexity screening is for planning support only. It does not change the decision you make.

Step 2: Approve

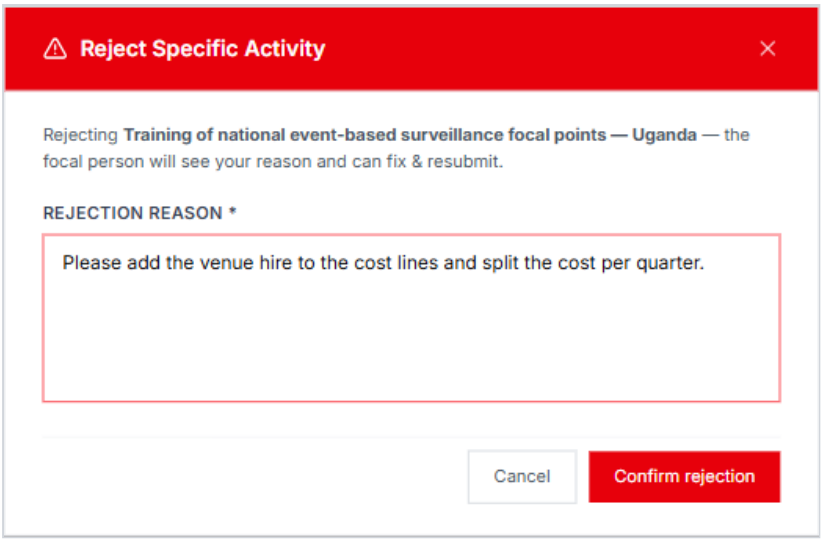
Click the **tick** button. A dialog asks you to confirm; click **Approve**. The activity becomes ■ Approved : it joins the live workplan, the Gantt chart and the dashboards, and the person who submitted it receives an email.



The approval dialog. The focal person can still change the activity later: it then comes back to you.

Or reject, with a reason

Click the **cross** button, write the **Rejection reason *** and click **Confirm rejection**. The reason is required. The activity becomes ■ Rejected ; the person who submitted it receives an email with your reason, and sees it in their list and in the Approval trail. They correct the activity and submit it again: it comes back to your list.



The rejection dialog. Say what to correct: the focal person sees exactly this text.

> Write a reason the focal person can act on: what is missing or wrong, and what you expect instead.

Country offices. A country office plans its own activities. If you are the Responsible Person of a country office, the activities of your office reach you in the same way.

5 The Approval trail

Every specific activity page ends with the section **Approval trail**: who did what, and when, oldest first. Focal persons, Responsible Persons, M&E and administrators see the same trail.

Event	Meaning
Created as draft	The activity was first saved.
Edited	Someone saved a change. Several saves in a row by the same person show as one line.
Submitted for approval	It was sent to you.
Approved / **Rejected**	Your decision. A rejection shows your reason in quotes.
Edited, sent back for approval	An approved activity was changed, so it came back to you.
Cancelled	The activity was withdrawn from the workplan.

The "Waiting for" line

While the activity is ■ In Review, the first line says whom it waits for, for example *Waiting for: Responsible Person A (Responsible Person of the Business Unit)*. When you see your name, the decision is yours.

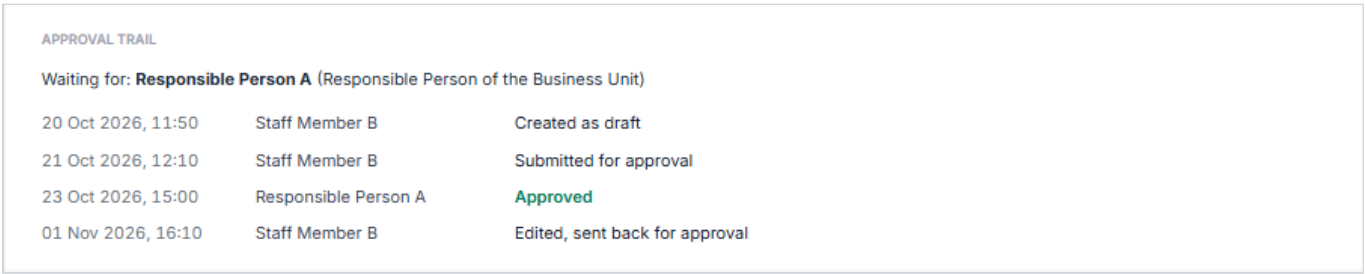


An activity in review: it waits for the Responsible Person of the Business Unit.

If the line reads *Waiting for: nobody: ask your administrator to name one in Org Structure*, no Responsible Person is named for the Business Unit or the ones above it. Ask the PR&A team to name one.

A changed activity comes back to you

When the focal person changes an activity you already approved, it goes back to ■ In Review by itself. The trail shows *Edited, sent back for approval*, and the activity is again in your Specific Activities tab.



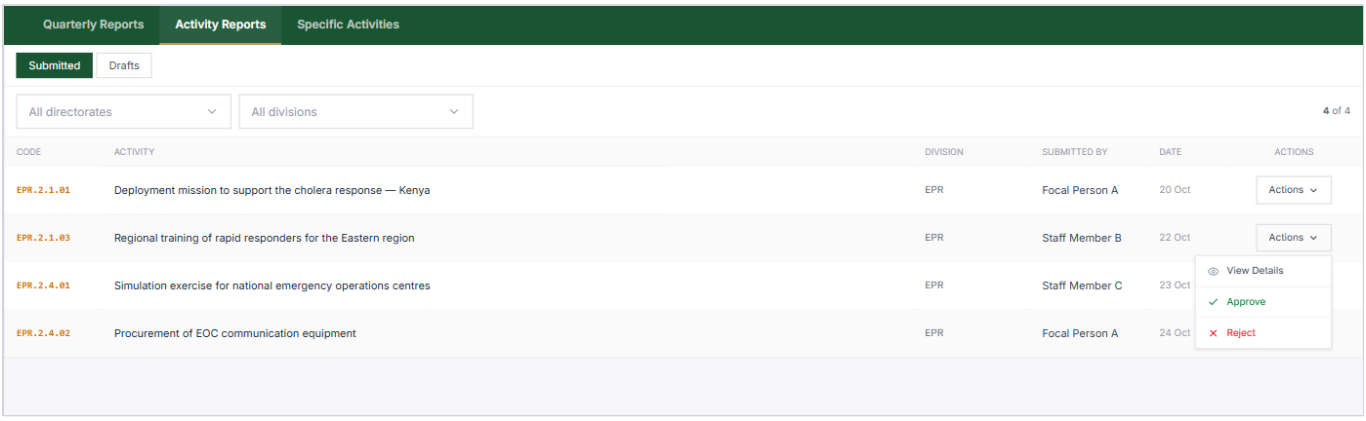
An approved activity edited by its focal person: it waits for you again.

Editing an activity in review

The review list has no edit button: to have something changed, reject the activity with a reason and the focal person corrects it. To correct a detail yourself, open the form of the activity: in the address of the activity page, `…/plan/node/<number>`, replace the end by `…/my-specifics/<number>/edit`. Save your change: the activity stays ■ In Review, still waiting for you, and the trail shows *Edited*. Then approve it.

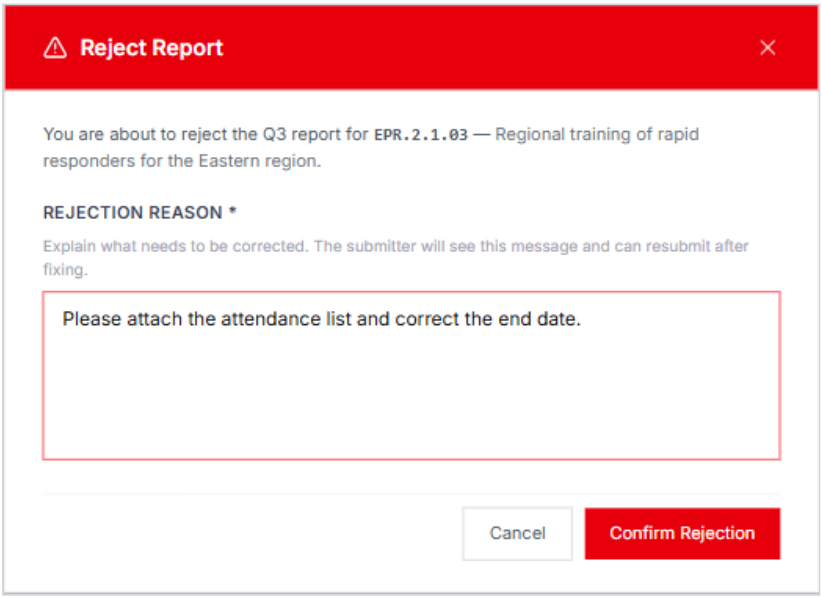
6 Approving activity reports

Open **Activities** › **Approve Activity Reports**, or **Review Submissions**, tab **Activity Reports**. The **Submitted** / **Drafts** switch chooses between reports waiting for a decision and reports still being written.



The Activity Reports tab: the Submitted / Drafts switch, the filters, and the Actions menu of a report (View Details, Approve, Reject).

- **View Details** opens the report as the author wrote it, following the Africa CDC Activity Reporting Template. It carries an **Approve Report** button.
- **Approve** (or **Approve Report** on the opened report) accepts it at once. It becomes ■ Approved and counts in the dashboards and exports.
- **Reject**, from the **Actions** menu of the row (the opened report has no Reject button), asks for a **Rejection Reason ***; click **Confirm Rejection**. The report becomes ■ Rejected and its author can fix it and submit it again.



The rejection dialog of an activity report. The author sees your message.

The author, the focal person and the Responsible Person of the Business Unit receive an email with the decision and, for a rejection, the reason. When the report comes from a Business Unit contributing to your activity, it is reviewed by the Responsible Person of that BU first, then by you, then signed off by M&E.

7 Approving quarterly indicator reports

When a quarterly indicator report needs you

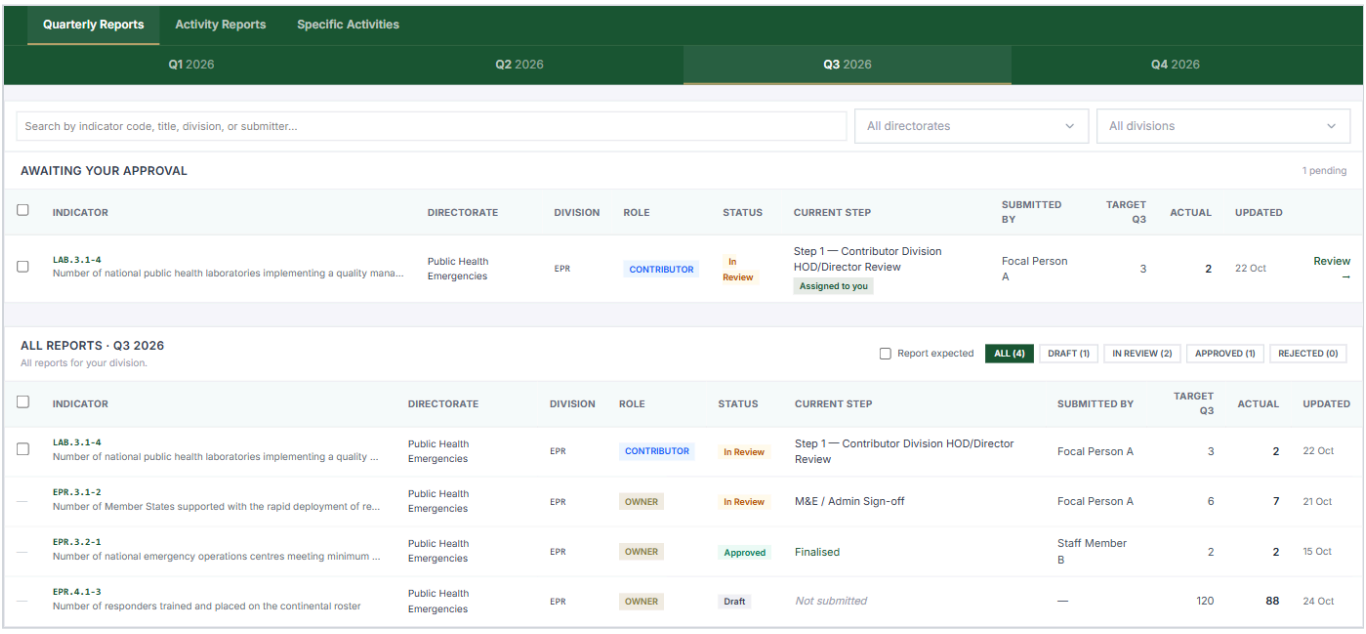
Each quarter, Business Units report the result of their Tier 3 and Tier 4 indicators. The steps depend on the role of the BU on the indicator:

Report written by	Steps
The **main BU** of the indicator (role *OWNER*)	M&E signs it off.
A **contributing BU** (role *CONTRIBUTOR*)	1. The Responsible Person of the contributing BU. 2. The Responsible Person of the main BU. 3. M&E signs it off.

Step 1: Find the report

Open **Indicators** › **Approve Indicator Reports**, or **Review Submissions**, tab **Quarterly Reports**, and pick the quarter. Two lists follow:

- **Awaiting Your Approval**: your action queue. The *Current Step* column says which step waits, and *Assigned to you* marks yours.
- **All Reports**: every report of your Business Units for the quarter, with its status and current step. Narrow it with the status chips (*All, Draft, In review, Approved, Rejected*) or tick *Report expected* to keep the indicators with a target this quarter.



> *The Quarterly Reports tab for Q3 2026: one report waits for you (a report of a contributing BU, Step 1), and the list of all the reports of your BU.*

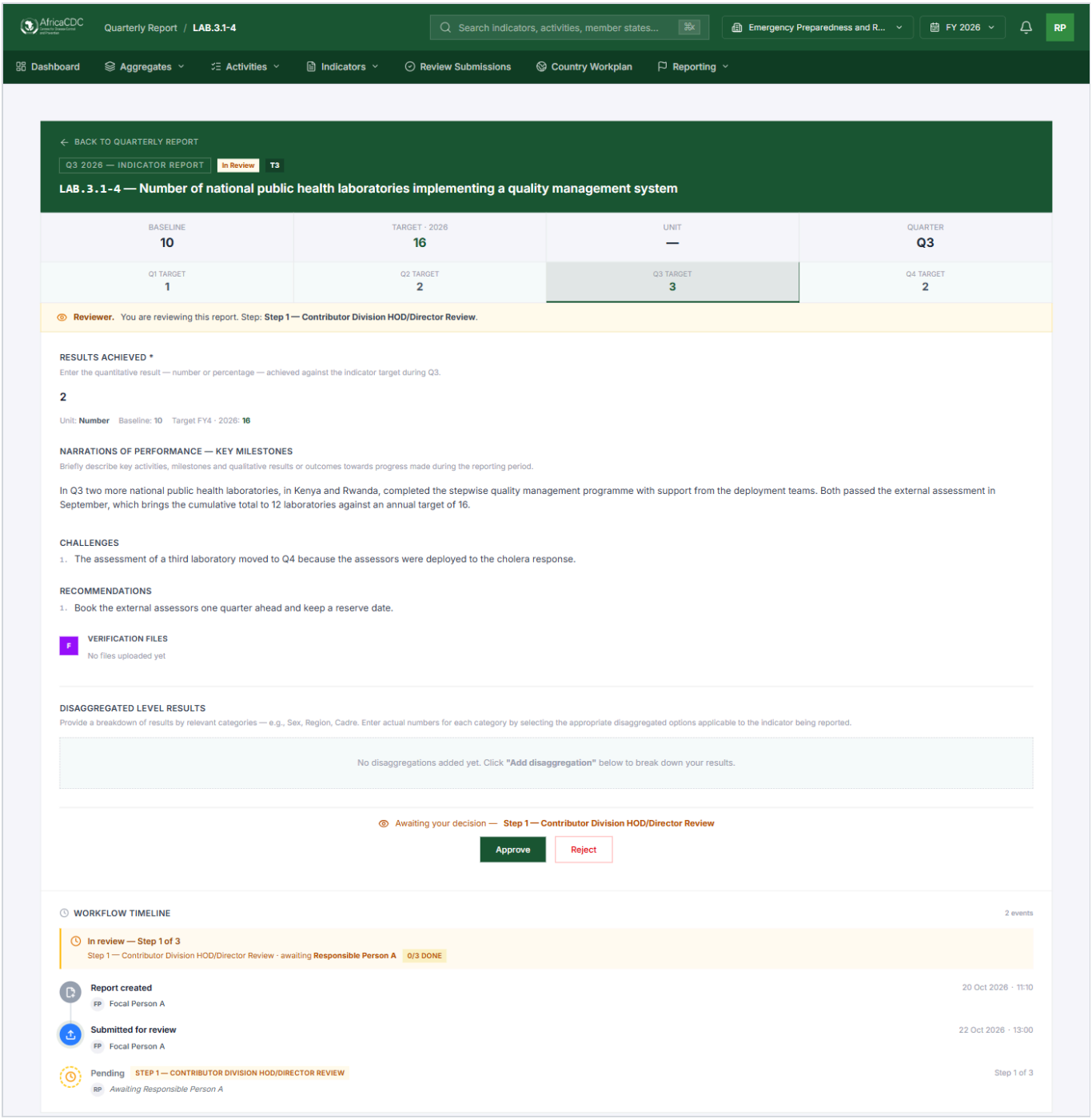
Step 2: Open it and decide

Click the row, or **Review** →. The report opens with a yellow line *Reviewer. You are reviewing this report* and the name of your step. Read the result, the narrative, the challenges, the recommendations and the files. At the

bottom:

- **Approve** passes the report to the next step, or ends the review at the last one.
- **Reject** asks for a reason (required) and sends the report back to its Business Unit. The focal person fixes it and submits it again.

The **Workflow Timeline** below shows what happened to the report and the steps still to come, with the person each one waits for.



> *A quarterly indicator report waiting for the Responsible Person: the reviewer line, the content, the Approve and Reject buttons, and the Workflow Timeline (step 1 of 3).*

Approving several reports at once

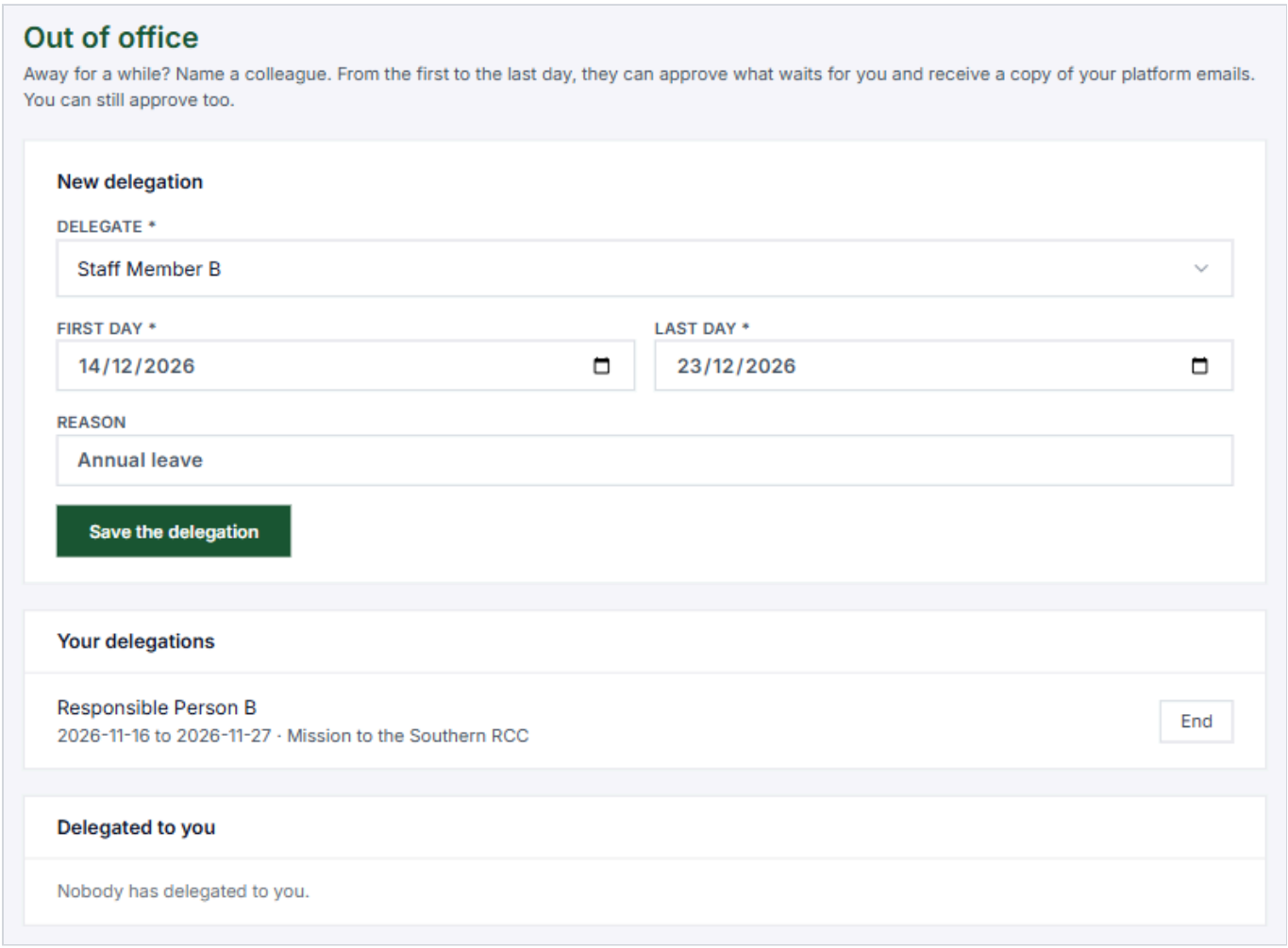
In **Awaiting Your Approval**, tick the reports assigned to you, then click **Approve selected** in the bar that appears. A dialog lists them; click **Approve <n>**. Useful at quarter close.

Report statuses

Status	What it means
Not started	No report has been opened for this activity or indicator yet.
Draft	Started and saved, not yet submitted.
Submitted	Submitted. It waits for the decision of the reviewer.
In review	An indicator or activity report on its way through its approval steps.
Approved	Accepted. It now counts in the dashboards and exports.
Rejected	Sent back with a reason. Fix it and submit it again.
N/A	Marked “not applicable”: no report is expected for this item this quarter.

8 Out of office

Away on mission or on leave? Name a colleague who approves for you while you are away. Click your initials at the top right, then **Out of office**.



The Out of office page: a new delegation being entered, and the delegation already planned.

1. Under **New delegation**, choose the **Delegate ***: type a name to find the colleague.
2. Choose the **First day *** and the **Last day ***. A delegation lasts at most 60 days.
3. Add a **Reason** if you wish (mission, leave), then click **Save the delegation**.

From the first to the last day, your delegate can approve or reject what waits for you, and sees it in their Review Submissions. They also receive a copy of your platform emails. You can still decide yourself.

- **Your delegations** lists the delegations you planned. **End**, then **Confirm end**, stops one before its last day.
- **Delegated to you** lists the colleagues who named you. While their delegation runs, what waits for them reaches you too.
- Two delegations cannot cover the same days: the message *A delegation already covers these dates: end it first* asks you to end the first one.
- The delegate must be an active user, and not yourself. A delegate cannot pass the delegation on.

9 Budget execution and the monthly digest

Budget execution to look at

After each budget execution import sent to the Business Units, the platform checks every broad activity that has a released budget, using the figures of the import. Two flags can appear:

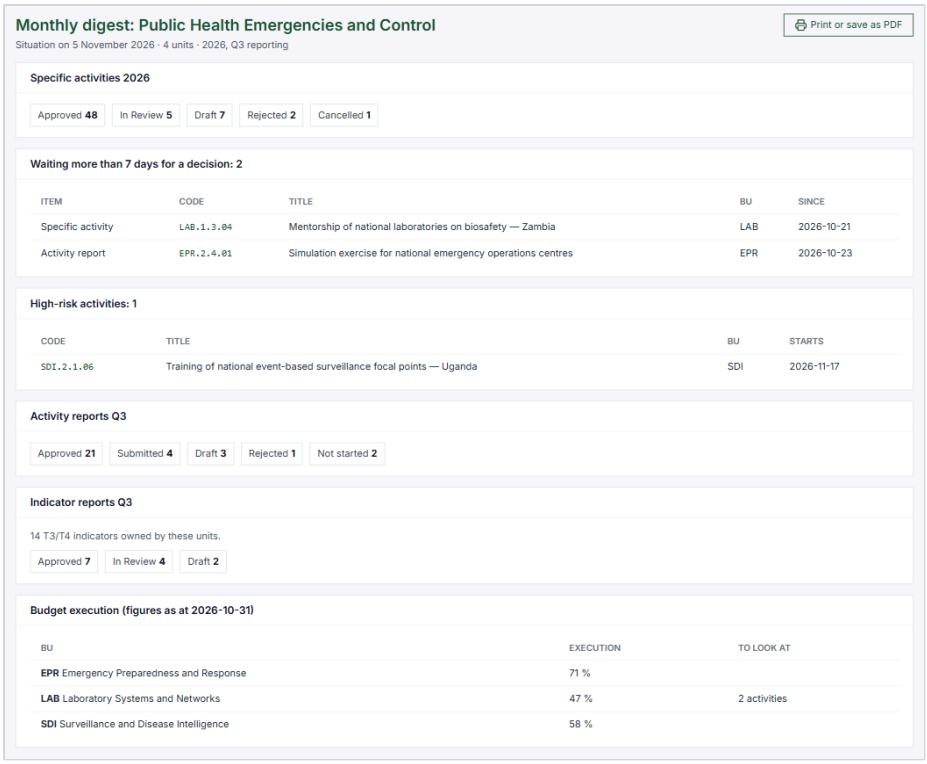
Flag	When
Over budget	More committed and spent than released: committed plus spent is above the released budget of the broad activity.
Slow execution	From the third quarter only: the broad activity has used much less than the time passed, more than 30 points behind (for example less than 20 % used when half of the year has passed).

Each Business Unit with flagged activities receives one email, *Budget execution to look at*, sent to its focal person and its Responsible Person. It gives the date of the budget execution figures and lists the flagged broad activities, with their execution rate and released budget. It is sent once per import.

On the **Dashboard**, the **Budget execution** block shows the same flag next to the title of the activity, in the table of activities. Point at the flag to read the reason. Click the activity to open the broad activity and its budget lines.

The monthly digest

On the first day of each month, the Responsible Person of each directorate receives the monthly digest of the directorate by email, with an **Open the full digest** button. The same page is in the menu: **Reporting** › **Monthly Digest**. It covers the directorate and every Business Unit under it.



> *The monthly digest of a directorate: activities by status, items waiting for a decision, high-risk activities, reports of the quarter and budget execution.*

Section	What it shows
Specific activities <year>	The specific activities of the year, counted by status.
Waiting more than 7 days for a decision	Specific activities, activity reports and quarterly indicator reports still waiting for a decision after 7 days, oldest first, with the date they wait since.
High-risk activities	The activities marked High risk, with their start date.
Activity reports <quarter>	The activity reports of the reporting quarter by status, and how many activities were declared not started.
Indicator reports <quarter>	The T3/T4 indicators owned by these Business Units, and their quarterly indicator reports by status.
Budget execution (figures as at …)	The execution rate of each Business Unit from the latest import, and the number of activities to look at.

The page shows the situation on the day you open it. **Print or save as PDF** prints it on A4; in the print window, choose to save as PDF to keep a copy. Click a code to open the activity.

> The digest is for the Responsible Person of a directorate and, while it runs, their out-of-office delegate. A Responsible Person of a division alone sees *No digest for you*.

10 Quick reference

I want to…	Go to
See everything waiting for me	**Review Submissions** (on the current year)
Approve or reject a specific activity	**Review Submissions** › **Specific Activities**
Decide from an email	The **Approve** / **Reject** button of the email
Read an activity before deciding	The **eye** button › the activity page
See who did what on an activity, and whom it waits for	The activity page › **Approval trail**
Approve or reject activity reports	**Activities** › **Approve Activity Reports**
Approve or reject quarterly indicator reports	**Indicators** › **Approve Indicator Reports**
Name a colleague who approves while I am away	Your initials › **Out of office**
Read the monthly digest of my directorate	**Reporting** › **Monthly Digest**
Find an activity, an indicator or a Business Unit	The search box at the top, or **Ctrl K**
Open a user guide, or its chapter on this page	**User guides** or **Help**, main menu
Take the tour of the screen again	Your initials › **Take the tour**

Statuses of a specific activity

Status	What it means
Draft	Saved but not submitted. Drafts stay private until you submit. Everything can still change.
In Review	Submitted. The Responsible Person of the Business Unit decides. It cannot be edited from the list while it waits.
Approved	Part of the workplan of the Business Unit. It shows in the Workplan and, if its place is a country with a country office, in the Country Workplan.
Rejected	Sent back with a reason. Edit it and submit it again.
Cancelled	Withdrawn from the workplan. It stays in the list for the record.

Good practice

- Decide within a few working days: the focal person cannot report on an activity until it is approved. After 7 days, the item is also opened to the Responsible Person of the level above.
- Always give a reason the focal person can act on when you reject.
- For changes to broad activities, indicators, targets or the reporting timeline, contact the PR&A team.

> **Need help?** Contact the PR&A team for the plan and the org structure, and the Software Developer Unit for the platform. This guide reflects the platform on 7 November 2026.